



tems that have not been updated. In addition to the operating system, also make sure your anti-virus software database and browser is up-to-date. Make sure you never download pirated software from the internet as they may contain malware.

- **Take offline periodic backups of your data.** Daily backups are the best way to avoid any data loss in case of an attack.
- **Make sure you download from credible sources** – Never download software or any content from unknown websites. Never click on random ads that pop-up with irresistible offers as these are the best places for hackers to leave adware that will hack your system data.
- **Never join public networks** as there are higher chances of a hacker to access your system and inject a virus program that can affect your system and other connected devices. The virus can also crash your system completely.

Phishing scams are used by hackers to make users enter their personal information with sensitive data like email address, contact number, credit card details, etc. Hackers create offer emails and special discount newsletters that tempt users with irresistible discounts and force them to enter their details. To avoid falling prey to phishing scams, website owners must follow these techniques –